addition to sugar, the cocoa plantations of Trinidad also absorbed a part of the Indian workforce. Once indenture contracts expired, many Indians began cane farming in the late 19th century. By the 1920s, they had started supplying a third of the produce to the sugar mills. Subsequently, Indians moved out of agriculture in greater numbers and began to assimilate with the wider society, experiencing marked upward mobility in education, occupation and employment in the 1970s and 1980s.[14] Representing 40 per cent of the million-strong population, people of Indian origin have held all major political offices in Trinidad and Tobago after it attained Independence in 1962. The country's per capita income grew to stand seven times higher than India's in 2010 and higher than any of the plantation economies that the Indians had migrated to.

In the late 19th century, a few thousand Indians were also brought to other Caribbean islands such as Grenada, St Vincent, St Lucia and St Kitts. Farther north, Jamaica received 40,000 Indians who worked on sugar and banana plantations. The French-ruled Guiana and the islands of Martinique and Guadeloupe collectively received nearly a 1,00,000 Indians, many of whom were from south India and had sailed from the ports of Pondicherry, Karaikal and Madras. These numbers were relatively small, and in all these regions, people of Indian origin today constitute less than 5 per cent of the local population.

Apart from the British and French colonies, Indians also migrated to Dutch Suriname, now known as the Republic of Suriname. The Dutch government abolished slavery in the Caribbean islands in 1863 and like the British and French before, planters faced the quandary of labour shortage as the freed slaves now had more bargaining power. After experimenting with labourers from different nationalities and a labour agreement being signed by the British and the Dutch in 1870, the indentured Indian workers arrived for the first time on board the ship *Lalla Rookh* in 1873.[15] They were followed by around 30,000 more Indians in the next four decades, of whom only a third returned to India. The Indians in Suriname were referred to as the Hindustanis. Thus began a slow process of assimilation into local society over the next 100 years. The Verenigde Hindoestaanse Partij (VHP)